



RECOVERY AND REGENERATION · PRACTICAL GUIDE

+50 Post-Match Recovery Workouts

A complete bank of recovery routines organized around the 48-72 hours that follow a match, to get back to training faster, stronger and with less injury risk.

Active recovery

Myofascial release

D+0 to D+2 plan

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Why recovery is part of training

A football match causes microscopic muscle damage, depletes a good part of your glycogen stores and leaves the central nervous system fatigued. What you do in the following hours determines how long your body takes to be 100% available again.

48-72 h

IS HOW LONG MUSCLE DAMAGE CAN
TAKE TO NORMALIZE AFTER A
DEMANDING MATCH

24-48 h

WINDOW IN WHICH ACTIVE RECOVERY IS
MORE EFFECTIVE THAN COMPLETE REST

3 phases

D+0, D+1 AND D+2, EACH WITH A
DIFFERENT GOAL

WHAT HAPPENS TO YOUR BODY AFTER PLAYING

- Micro-damage in muscle fibers from braking, accelerations and collisions.
- Partial depletion of muscle glycogen stores.
- Accumulated central nervous system fatigue, not just muscular.
- Localized inflammation, normal and necessary for tissue repair.
- Dehydration and loss of electrolytes through sweat.



KEY TIP

Absolute rest is not the best strategy: gentle, controlled movement (active recovery) helps clear metabolites and speeds the return to normal better than staying still all day.

PLANNING



The 48-72 hours that define your week

This ebook organizes the routines according to the exact moment you will apply them, from the final whistle until you're ready to return to training as normal.

MOMENT	MAIN GOAL	INTENSITY
D+0 (same day)	Cool down, hydrate, reduce inflammation	Very low
D+1 (next day)	Move without overloading, activate circulation	Low
D+2 (second day)	Reintroduce activation and light strength	Low-medium
D+3 onward	Return to the usual training plan	According to planning



KEY TIP

Add 1-2 targeted myofascial release routines on any of these days, focused on the muscle group that felt the most load in the match.



How to use this routine bank

Each routine is designed to be completed in 10-20 minutes. Choose the one that matches the day you're on, and record how you feel at the end of each one.

1. Identify which post-match day you're on (D+0, D+1 or D+2).
2. Choose any routine from that block: they're designed to rotate, there is no fixed order.
3. Add a myofascial release routine if you have a particularly loaded area.
4. Complete the log at the end of each sheet: it helps you detect patterns week by week.



WARNING

If the muscle soreness is much greater than usual, doesn't ease with these routines within 3-4 days, or comes with marked swelling, consult a health professional before continuing with your normal training plan.



BLOCK 1 OF 4

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Twelve routines to apply in the first hours after the match, prioritizing active cool-down, hydration and reduction of acute inflammation.

12 routines · 5-10 minutes each

Intensity: very low

Timing: same day as the match

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Lower your heart rate and activate recovery in the first 30-60 minutes after the final whistle.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Easy cool-down jog (5 minutes)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Seated adductor stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Recovery meal (carbohydrate + protein)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Legs-up-the-wall (5 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps

**COACH'S TIP**

Do this routine within the first 30-60 minutes after the match: the sooner you start, the better.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Reduce acute inflammation and prepare the body for the night's rest.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Standing quadriceps stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Wall calf stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Seated adductor stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Deep diaphragmatic breathing	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

You don't need to do all 12 steps of the bank: choose 4-5 depending on what you have available in the locker room or at home.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Combine active cool-down with immediate hydration and nutrition.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Easy cool-down jog (5 minutes)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Standing quadriceps stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Wall calf stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Recovery meal (carbohydrate + protein)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

The recovery meal doesn't have to be perfect: prioritize something practical as soon as you can eat.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Prioritize the areas that were most demanded during the match.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Seated adductor stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Deep diaphragmatic breathing	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Hydration with electrolytes	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Recovery meal (carbohydrate + protein)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

If you played in extreme heat, prioritize hydration with electrolytes over everything else.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Lower central nervous system activation before sleeping.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Easy cool-down jog (5 minutes)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Standing quadriceps stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Wall calf stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Hot-cold contrast shower	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

Local ice makes more sense for specific knocks or overloads than for the whole body as a routine.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+0 · Immediate recovery

Leave the body in the best possible condition to start D+1.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Easy cool-down jog (5 minutes)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Wall calf stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Hydration with electrolytes	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Recovery meal (carbohydrate + protein)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

Sleeping well tonight is worth as much as any step in this routine.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+0 · Immediate recovery

Lower your heart rate and activate recovery in the first 30-60 minutes after the final whistle.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Easy cool-down jog (5 minutes)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Standing hamstring stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Wall calf stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Hot-cold contrast shower	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

Do this routine within the first 30-60 minutes after the match: the sooner you start, the better.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Reduce acute inflammation and prepare the body for the night's rest.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Standing hamstring stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Seated adductor stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Hydration with electrolytes	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Recovery meal (carbohydrate + protein)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

You don't need to do all 12 steps of the bank: choose 4-5 depending on what you have available in the locker room or at home.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+0 · Immediate recovery

Combine active cool-down with immediate hydration and nutrition.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Standing quadriceps stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Seated adductor stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Compression socks or sleeves	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Legs-up-the-wall (5 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Hot-cold contrast shower	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

The recovery meal doesn't have to be perfect: prioritize something practical as soon as you can eat.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Prioritize the areas that were most demanded during the match.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Standing quadriceps stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Wall calf stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Seated adductor stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Local ice on demanded areas (10-15 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Hot-cold contrast shower	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

If you played in extreme heat, prioritize hydration with electrolytes over everything else.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Lower central nervous system activation before sleeping.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Easy cool-down jog (5 minutes)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Wall calf stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Hydration with electrolytes	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Recovery meal (carbohydrate + protein)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Legs-up-the-wall (5 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

Local ice makes more sense for specific knocks or overloads than for the whole body as a routine.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

D+0 · Immediate recovery

Leave the body in the best possible condition to start D+1.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Easy cool-down jog (5 minutes)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Standing hamstring stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Wall calf stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Seated adductor stretch	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps
	Legs-up-the-wall (5 min)	1-2	5-10 min / depending on exercise	No pause between steps



COACH'S TIP

Sleeping well tonight is worth as much as any step in this routine.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 2 OF 4

D+1 · Active recovery

Thirteen gentle-movement routines to activate circulation and recover range of motion without adding new fatigue.

13 routines · 10-20 minutes each

Intensity: low

Timing: day after the match



D+1 · Active recovery

Activate circulation without adding new fatigue to the body.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Very easy regenerative jog (15-20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Swimming or pool walking	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full ankle mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Spine mobility (cat-cow)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Light outdoor walk (20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

The intensity today should feel very comfortable: if it starts to feel like a workout, slow down.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Recover range of motion in the most demanded joints.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Very easy regenerative jog (15-20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full hip mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Light outdoor walk (20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Sleep priority: 8+ hours tonight	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

The pool (gentle swimming or walking in water) is one of the best recovery tools if you have access to one.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Reduce the muscle stiffness typical of the day after playing.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on hamstrings	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on calves	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Deep posterior chain stretch	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Light outdoor walk (20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

Choose the 5 routines based on how you feel: you don't need to do all 13 on the same day.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Sustain recovery with low-intensity movement instead of complete rest.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Very easy regenerative jog (15-20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full hip mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on calves	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Spine mobility (cat-cow)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

The typical next-day muscle soreness (DOMS) improves with gentle movement, not with complete rest.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Prepare the body to reintroduce load on D+2.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full ankle mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on calves	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Deep posterior chain stretch	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Spine mobility (cat-cow)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

If you slept badly the night of the match, prioritize sleep over any other routine in this block today.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Combine gentle movement with targeted myofascial release.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Deep posterior chain stretch	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Spine mobility (cat-cow)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Light outdoor walk (20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Sleep priority: 8+ hours tonight	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

Record your stiffness level from 1 to 10 before and after: you'll notice the difference.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Activate circulation without adding new fatigue to the body.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full hip mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on calves	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Guided breathing and relaxation	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Sleep priority: 8+ hours tonight	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

The intensity today should feel very comfortable: if it starts to feel like a workout, slow down.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Recover range of motion in the most demanded joints.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Swimming or pool walking	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full hip mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on quadriceps	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on hamstrings	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Guided breathing and relaxation	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

The pool (gentle swimming or walking in water) is one of the best recovery tools if you have access to one.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Reduce the muscle stiffness typical of the day after playing.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Swimming or pool walking	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full ankle mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Light outdoor walk (20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Guided breathing and relaxation	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

Choose the 5 routines based on how you feel: you don't need to do all 13 on the same day.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Sustain recovery with low-intensity movement instead of complete rest.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Swimming or pool walking	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full hip mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Guided breathing and relaxation	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Sleep priority: 8+ hours tonight	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

The typical next-day muscle soreness (DOMS) improves with gentle movement, not with complete rest.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Prepare the body to reintroduce load on D+2.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Foam roller on quadriceps	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on calves	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Spine mobility (cat-cow)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Guided breathing and relaxation	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Sleep priority: 8+ hours tonight	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

If you slept badly the night of the match, prioritize sleep over any other routine in this block today.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Combine gentle movement with targeted myofascial release.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Very easy regenerative jog (15-20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Low-intensity regenerative cycling	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full hip mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on hamstrings	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Foam roller on calves	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

Record your stiffness level from 1 to 10 before and after: you'll notice the difference.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+1 · Active recovery

Activate circulation without adding new fatigue to the body.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Full hip mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Full ankle mobility	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Deep posterior chain stretch	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Spine mobility (cat-cow)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue
	Light outdoor walk (20 min)	1	10-20 min / depending on exercise	Comfortable pace, no fatigue



COACH'S TIP

The intensity today should feel very comfortable: if it starts to feel like a workout, slow down.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 3 OF 4

D+2 · Transition to training

Thirteen routines to reintroduce activation, technique and light strength before returning to the usual training plan.

13 routines · 12-18 minutes each

Intensity: low-medium

Timing: second day after the match



D+2 · Transition to training

Reintroduce muscle and core activation before returning to normal training.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Gentle walking lunge	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	General dynamic mobility	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Sensation check and RPE before training	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Dynamic core activation (gentle mountain climbers)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

This block is the bridge between recovery and normal training: the intensity should be low-medium, never maximal.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Assess how the body responds to a slightly greater stimulus than on D+1.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Core activation (gentle plank)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle technical skipping	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Single-leg balance	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Shoulder and upper-body mobility	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

Pay attention to asymmetries: if one side feels noticeably heavier or stiffer, add an extra routine for that side.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Recover the technique of key movements (squat, lunge, changes of direction) without intensity.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Core activation (gentle plank)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Controlled bodyweight squat	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle changes of direction	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Shoulder and upper-body mobility	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Dynamic core activation (gentle mountain climbers)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

The sensation and RPE check gives you objective information to decide whether you train normally the next day.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Finish reducing the residual stiffness from the match.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Controlled bodyweight squat	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Foam roller on lower and mid back	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Shoulder and upper-body mobility	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Dynamic core activation (gentle mountain climbers)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

If on D+2 you still feel sharp pain (not just stiffness), extend the D+1 block one more day.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Prepare the nervous system for the next full training session.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	General dynamic mobility	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle changes of direction	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Controlled glute bridge	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Dynamic core activation (gentle mountain climbers)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

Use this routine as the warm-up for your next training session, not as an isolated session.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Confirm, with the sensation check, whether you're ready to train without restrictions.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Core activation (gentle plank)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Controlled bodyweight squat	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Single-leg balance	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Controlled glute bridge	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

Technique matters more than intensity: it's time to recalibrate the movement, not to chase performance.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Reintroduce muscle and core activation before returning to normal training.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Core activation (gentle plank)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Controlled bodyweight squat	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle walking lunge	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle changes of direction	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Sensation check and RPE before training	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

This block is the bridge between recovery and normal training: the intensity should be low-medium, never maximal.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Assess how the body responds to a slightly greater stimulus than on D+1.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Core activation (gentle plank)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle technical skipping	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle changes of direction	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Shoulder and upper-body mobility	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Dynamic core activation (gentle mountain climbers)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

Pay attention to asymmetries: if one side feels noticeably heavier or stiffer, add an extra routine for that side.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Recover the technique of key movements (squat, lunge, changes of direction) without intensity.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Core activation (gentle plank)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Controlled bodyweight squat	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle changes of direction	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Foam roller on lower and mid back	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

The sensation and RPE check gives you objective information to decide whether you train normally the next day.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Finish reducing the residual stiffness from the match.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Gentle walking lunge	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Single-leg balance	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Sensation check and RPE before training	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Dynamic core activation (gentle mountain climbers)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

If on D+2 you still feel sharp pain (not just stiffness), extend the D+1 block one more day.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Prepare the nervous system for the next full training session.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Core activation (gentle plank)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Controlled bodyweight squat	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle technical skipping	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Foam roller on lower and mid back	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

Use this routine as the warm-up for your next training session, not as an isolated session.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Confirm, with the sensation check, whether you're ready to train without restrictions.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Progressive jog (10-15 min)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle technical skipping	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle changes of direction	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Sensation check and RPE before training	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Dynamic core activation (gentle mountain climbers)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

Technique matters more than intensity: it's time to recalibrate the movement, not to chase performance.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



D+2 · Transition to training

Reintroduce muscle and core activation before returning to normal training.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Core activation (gentle plank)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Gentle walking lunge	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	General dynamic mobility	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Controlled glute bridge	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec
	Dynamic core activation (gentle mountain climbers)	2	8-12 reps / 20-30 sec	30-45 sec



COACH'S TIP

This block is the bridge between recovery and normal training: the intensity should be low-medium, never maximal.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



BLOCK 4 OF 4

Targeted myofascial release

Twelve foam-roller routines, one for each key muscle group of the footballer. Add the one that matches your most loaded area on any of the days D+0 to D+2.

12 routines · 8-10 minutes each

Intensity: very low

Timing: any day, as needed



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Hamstrings. Back of the thigh, between glute and knee.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on hamstrings	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static hamstring stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Quadriceps. Front of the thigh, from hip to knee.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on quadriceps	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static quadriceps stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Calves and soleus. Entire calf, from knee to heel.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on calves and soleus	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static calf and soleus stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Glutes. The entire glute area, including the deep glute.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on glutes	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static glute stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Adductors. Inner thigh.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on adductors	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static adductor stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Lower and mid back. Lower and middle back, with caution around the spine.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on lower and mid back	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static lower and mid back stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: IT band. Outer side of the thigh, from hip to knee.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on IT band	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static IT band stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Chest and front shoulder. Chest and front part of the shoulder.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on chest and front shoulder	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static chest and front shoulder stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Piriformis (deep glute). Deep area of the glute, near the sciatic nerve.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on piriformis (deep glute)	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static piriformis (deep glute) stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Plantar fascia. Sole of the foot, with a small ball instead of a roller.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow rolling on plantar fascia	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static plantar fascia stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Trapezius and neck. Upper back and base of the neck, with caution.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on trapezius and neck	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static trapezius and neck stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)



Targeted myofascial release

Release tension and improve tissue quality in: Psoas and hip flexors. Deep area of the lower abdomen and hip.

	EXERCISE	SETS	DURATION	REST
	Slow foam roller on psoas and hip flexors	2-3	45-60 sec	20-30 sec
	Static psoas and hip flexor stretch	2	25-30 sec	15 sec
	Light activation of the worked area	1	8-10 reps	—



COACH'S TIP

Look for firm but tolerable pressure, never sharp pain: 45-60 seconds per area, breathing deeply and steadily throughout the entire roller pass.

LOG (DATE · LOAD/INTENSITY · RPE 1-10 · NOTES)

TO CLOSE

Recovery is one more workout

No strength, speed or endurance plan performs at its best if recovery between sessions isn't up to par. These 50 routines are here so that recovery stops being improvised and becomes a planned part of your week.



Apply a D+0 routine within the first hour after every match.



Don't confuse total rest with recovery: gentle movement speeds up the process.



Add targeted myofascial release on your most demanded area each week.



Use the D+2 sensation check to decide whether you're ready to train without restrictions.



For sharp pain or pain that doesn't improve in 3-4 days, consult a health professional.



This material is for educational and general training purposes. It is not a medical diagnosis or treatment. For injuries, persistent pain or pre-existing conditions, always consult a qualified health professional.